

WILL THE LAST FULL BUDGET BEFORE THE GENERAL ELECTIONS BE A POPULIST ONE, AIMED AT PLEASING THE VOTE BANKS? UNLIKELY, BECAUSE INDIA'S ECONOMIC TRAJECTORY NEEDS BIG DOSES OF GROWTH HORMONES, AND CAN DO WITHOUT ANY ADVENTURISM

BY ALOKESH BHATTACHARYYA

PHOTOS BY **BANDEEP SINGH**

A TIME OF RECKONING